

Trophy

Baker Settles It in Round One

Jon Baker had never won a thing in TEG; by the end of the opening round at Boavista the only live question was the size of the margin.

Jon Baker won the TEG 3 Trophy at 18 under par net, 18 shots clear of David Mullin. It was his first. After the opening day the margin never really looked like closing, and the remaining three rounds were conducted largely as a formality with witnesses.

The first round set the tone: nine under net, the best round recorded in TEG history to that point. The gross figure behind it, +19, was the third-best gross round then on record, and the 90 it produced was a Boavista personal best. His previous best over three prior visits to the Lagos parkland was 100. That is a 17-stroke improvement on his last time round the place, which is less a step forward than a change of species.

Round two brought two under. Round three brought seven under, which at the time stood as the second-best round in TEG

history. The middle of it did the damage. Across holes 6 to 10 Baker took seven shots off par net, playing them in two over gross with strokes in hand at almost every turn, the golf of a man who has read the rulebook and found it agreeable.

He then closed the same round with a nine at the 18th. A quintuple bogey. It cost him three net shots and made no difference at all to the outcome. A lead of that size permits the occasional gesture, and this was a magnificent one, delivered without apology and without consequence.

He led the Trophy after round three, with Mullin leading the TEG 3 Green Jacket. A further four-shot net gain through holes 7 to 9 on the final day removed any remaining question. What was left was not a contest but an escort.

AT A GLANCE
Trophy Winner Jon Baker (1st Trophy) Runner-up: David Mullin
Green Jacket David Mullin (2nd Jacket) Runner-up: Stuart Neumann
Wooden Spoon Henry Meller (2nd Spoon) Next above: Stuart Neumann

FINAL · Trophy
JB -18 DM 0 GW +7 SN +12 HM +16
FINAL · Green Jacket
DM +72 SN +84 JB +94 HM +96 GW +127

Green Jacket | David Mullin

Mullin Rewrites Boavista, Loses His Crown

Stripped of the Trophy he won in TEG 2, David Mullin responded with the lowest gross round in Boavista's history and a Green Jacket won by twelve.

David Mullin took the TEG 3 Green Jacket at +72 gross, twelve clear of Stuart Neumann, over four rounds played on the same Howard Swan parkland at Boavista in the Algarve in October 2010.

The tone was set in the opening round. Mullin's +17 gross was, at that point, the best gross round anyone had recorded in TEG competition. By the third round he had bettered it himself. That 85

gross, +14, was a new Boavista course record, taking four strokes off the 89 that had stood across fifteen previous visits to the course. It was also a personal course best, since the 89 in question was his own, set in TEG 2. He has now beaten himself and everybody else with a single card. In net terms the round came in at -4, the third-best round in TEG history to date. Neumann answered on the same day with +18 gross, but the gap was

already too wide to be addressed by good manners.

It was not a flawless trip. In the second round Mullin ran up a 9 at the 17th, a quintuple bogey and his worst return on a par 4. In the final round he took 7 at the par-three 11th. Neither cost him anything material. With a twelve-shot margin over Neumann, the Jacket had been decided long before the errors were entitled to an opinion.

Wooden Spoon | Henry Meller

A 12, an 89, and the Spoon

Henry Meller played the best round anyone managed in TEG 3 and still finished four adrift of Stuart Neumann, retaining the Wooden Spoon he brought with him from TEG 2.

Henry Meller's TEG 3 contained both the worst hole yet recorded and one of the best rounds. At Boavista's 17th in round one he took 12 on a par four, eight over, the heaviest single-hole loss to par in TEG history to that point and the worst of his own career. It dropped him to the bottom of the TEG 3 Wooden Spoon race, a position he had been loitering near in any case.

The next day he shot 18 over gross for a net score of two under par. That is 89 strokes, the second-best round and second-best gross round in TEG history to date. It was also his best score at Boavista, two shots better than the 91 he had managed on his previous visit in TEG 2, on a course he was playing for the seventh time. For one afternoon he was the finest golfer in the field, and he had the decency not to mention it.

Round three undid it, methodically and without hurry. A triple bogey at the 1st. A 10 at the par-five 3rd. A quadruple bogey at the 6th. That sent him back to last in the Spoon race, the bleeding stopped only by a birdie at the 11th; he was far stronger on the front nine than the back. Round four brought another quadruple bogey, at the 7th, before three straight gross pars from the 12th, by which point the arithmetic had long since stopped listening.

He finished 16 over net, and collected the Wooden Spoon. He had, at various moments, the best round of the tournament and the worst hole in the history of the thing. Only one of them came with a prize.

Sidebar

Boavista's 17th Eats Three Men

A short par four rated the second-easiest hole at Boavista took a 12 off Henry Meller, a 9 off David Mullin and a 10 off Stuart Neumann in the space of four rounds.

The 17th at Boavista Golf & Spa Resort is a par 4 carrying stroke index 17, which makes it the second-easiest hole on Howard Swan's parkland layout in Lagos. Across the four rounds of TEG 3, played there from 5 to 8 October 2010, it collected three of the trip's worst individual scores. It has no reputation whatsoever. It has, on the evidence, a body count.

Henry Meller went first. In round one he took 12 shots at the hole, eight over par and, after handicap, seven over net. It is the worst score relative to par that Meller has recorded, and the worst any player has recorded against par in TEG history.

David Mullin followed in round two with a 9, a quintuple bogey and five over par, also the heaviest single-hole loss of his own career. Stuart Neumann completed the set in round four, running up a 10 for a sextuple bogey, six over par, likewise a personal worst. Three men, three careers, three new low points, all filed at the same undistinguished address.

The oddity is that none of the three found Boavista difficult overall. All had played the course three times before this trip, and all three set new course bests during it: Mullin an 85 in round three, Meller an 89 in round two, Neumann an 89 in round three. Each improved on his previous visit, Mullin by four strokes, Neumann by three, Meller by two. The 17th simply took its own toll, quietly, as it always had.

Gregg Williams

Four Quadruples and a Personal Best

Gregg Williams dropped thirteen shots over the last four holes of R1 and twelve in four holes of R2 — then went round Boavista in 97, his best there yet.

Gregg Williams spent four days at Boavista swinging between the two extremes of his game, apparently at random. Round one ended in collapse: triple bogeys at the 15th, 16th and 17th, then a quadruple-bogey 8 at the last. Thirteen shots gone in four holes, and not a single net par among them.

Round two produced the same shape, relocated to the middle of the card. A triple at the 8th, a double at the 9th, a quadruple-bogey 8 at the 10th and a triple at the 11th. Twelve shots dropped across another four-hole stretch without a net par, undoing at a stroke the run at the 3rd, 4th and 5th that had put him four net shots to the good. He has a gift for building things and a matching gift for standing near them afterwards.

Round three began just as badly, with a quadruple-bogey 7 at the par-3 2nd, which dropped him to the bottom of the TEG 3 Wooden Spoon race. What followed was the best golf of his life. Williams signed for 97, four under net par: his best gross round at Boavista on his sixth visit to the course, eight strokes better than his previous visit and well inside the 105 he had managed at TEG 2. It stands as the third-best round in TEG history to date, and nobody who watched round one saw it coming.

Round four returned to type, with quadruple bogeys at the 3rd, the 7th and the 12th.

Records & Personal Bests

Notable achievements: TEG 3

Teg Records

- Jon Baker's -7 is the 2nd-best round in TEG history to date (R3)
- Gregg Williams's -4 is the 3rd-best round in TEG history to date (R3)
- Henry Meller's -2 is the 2nd-best round in TEG history to date (R2)
- Henry Meller's +18 (gross) is the 2nd-best Gross round in TEG history to date (R2)
- Stuart Neumann's +18 (gross) is the 3rd-best Gross round in TEG history to date (R3)
- Jon Baker's -9 is the best round in TEG history to date (R1)
- David Mullin's +14 (gross) is the best Gross round in TEG history to date (R3)
- Jon Baker's +19 (gross) is the 3rd-best Gross round in TEG history to date (R1)
- David Mullin's -4 is the 3rd-best round in TEG history to date (R3)
- Jon Baker's -2 is the 2nd-best round in TEG history to date (R2)
- David Mullin's +17 (gross) is the best Gross round in TEG history to date (R1)
- David Mullin's -1 is the 3rd-best round in TEG history to date (R1)

Rare Feats

- Stuart Neumann runs up a 10 (+6) at the 17th (R4) — his career-worst on a par-4
- Henry Meller runs up a 12 (+8) at the 17th (R1) — a new TEG-record and career-worst on a par-4
- Henry Meller runs up a 10 (+5) at the 3rd (R3) — his career-worst on a par-5
- David Mullin runs up a 9 (+5) at the 17th (R2) — his career-worst on a par-4